Mehfil-e-Zan

Gather. Grow. Glow.

OPERATIONS AND QUALITY CONTROL STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Smooth days, consistent quality and quick fixes when things go wrong

Document ID	MEZ-SOP-010 (assumed)
Document title	Operations and Quality Control SOP
Version	1.0
Effective date	01 November 2026 (assumed)
Last review date	Not yet reviewed (first issue)
Next review date	01 November 2027
Document owner	Operations Officer
Approval authority	CEO and Owner
Status	Draft for approval
Applies to	All employees, trainees, interns, instructors and contractors who work in the cafe, work corner, events, kitchen, stores or front desk

Student project note: *This document is a student project deliverable. Shift times, temperatures, stock levels, response times and targets are business assumptions. Food safety, fire, health and labour rules must be checked for Pakistan and Sindh, and reviewed by a qualified adviser, before a real business adopts this SOP.*

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

Guests come back when every visit feels the same: a warm welcome, good food, a clean and calm space, and events that start on time. This SOP describes our daily routines and quality checks so that every shift delivers the same standard, problems are found early and fixes are recorded.

1.2 Scope

It covers daily task allocation, workflows for opening, service, events and closing, delivery of each service, quality checkpoints, stock management, progress reporting, delays and issues, corrective and preventive actions, and daily, weekly and monthly reports.

1.3 Business assumptions

- Mehfil-e-Zan is a women-only cafe and community space in Gulshan-e-Iqbal, Karachi, open daily from 10:00 AM to 10:00 PM, with 40 seats.
- Services: the cafe, reading and work corner, weekly events and workshops, mothers' meetups and private bookings.
- Each day has a morning shift (9:00 AM to 5:30 PM) and an evening shift (2:00 PM to 10:30 PM), with an overlap from 2:00 PM to 5:30 PM (MEZ-POL-002).
- A typical shift has a Supervisor, 2 to 3 cafe staff, 1 kitchen helper, 1 cleaner and the Operations Officer or Sales Executive on duty.

1.4 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Link to this SOP
MEZ-SOP-001	General Office SOP	Conduct, escalation
MEZ-SOP-002	Security Measures SOP	Access, incidents, emergency
MEZ-SOP-008	Client Communication and Engagement Ethics SOP	Complaints, bookings, promises
MEZ-SOP-009	Finance and Expense Management SOP	Purchases, petty cash, stock value
MEZ-POL-001	IT Rules and Regulations Policy	POS, WiFi, backups
MEZ-POL-002	HR and Employee Management Policy	Rosters, attendance, training
MEZ-GDL-001	Marketing and Brand Guidelines	Event promotion, reviews
MEZ-FRM-048 to 052	Operations forms (Annexes A to E)	Checklists, tasks, incidents, CAPA, inspection

Note: *Document and form numbers are assumed and should be matched to the master Document Register.*

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities under this SOP
Owner and CEO	Approve this SOP, major changes to services, and serious corrective actions. Review monthly operations reports.
Operations Officer	Owns this SOP. Plans the week, allocates tasks, manages suppliers and stock, schedules maintenance, leads quality checks and closes corrective actions.
Supervisor	Runs the shift. Allocates tasks, checks quality, handles guest issues, signs checklists and writes the daily report.
Sales Executive	Manages bookings and events with the Operations Officer. Confirms details with clients and checks event readiness.
Marketing Executive	Promotes events accurately and shares the final schedule and capacity limits.
Finance Director	Approves purchases and stock write-offs. Checks stock value and costs.
IT Manager	Keeps WiFi, POS, sockets and booking tools working. Responds to IT faults.
Security & Safety Manager	Checks safety, fire equipment, access and incident response. Leads drills.
Documentation & Compliance Coordinator	Files checklists and reports. Checks that records and CAPA actions are complete.
HR / Sales / Marketing Manager	Trains staff on this SOP and handles people issues found in quality checks.
Cafe, kitchen and cleaning staff	Follow routines and checklists, keep hygiene standards, report problems and stock gaps immediately.

3. Quality Principles

Principle	What it means in practice
Safe and private first	Food safety, fire safety and guest privacy are never compromised to save time.
Same standard every time	Recipes, portions, set-ups and service steps follow written standards.
Clean and calm	Tables, washrooms, the prayer area and the reading corner are always tidy.
Right first time	Check before serving or handing over, not after a guest complains.
Tell early	A delay or fault is reported when it is first noticed, with a fix or alternative.
Learn from problems	Every issue is recorded and fixed at the root cause.

4. Daily Task Allocation

4.1 Planning

- The Operations Officer prepares the weekly roster and event plan every Thursday for the next week.
- Before each shift, the Supervisor holds a 10-minute huddle: bookings and events, special orders, stock gaps, staff absences, and one quality focus for the day.

- Tasks are written on the Daily Task Allocation sheet (Annex B) with the name, task, time and check-off. Each task has one owner and a backup.

4.2 Standard stations

Station	Main tasks	Staff per shift (assumed)
Front desk and host	Welcome, seating, memberships, bookings, cash and receipts, phone and WhatsApp	1
Cafe counter and bar	Chai, coffee, mocktails, desserts, till	2
Kitchen	Parathas, sandwiches and snacks, preparation, food safety	1 to 2
Floor and service	Tables, orders, clearing, guest care, work and reading corner checks	1 to 2
Cleaning	Washrooms, floors, prayer area, bins, deep-clean tasks	1
Events	Set-up, guest register, instructor support, pack-down	As needed

5. Daily Workflow

5.1 Timeline

Time (assumed)	Activity	Owner
9:00 to 10:00 AM	Opening: unlock, power on equipment, safety walk-through, cleaning check, prep, stock and cash check, WiFi test (Annex A)	Morning Supervisor
10:00 AM	Doors open. Welcome guests. Pass check at the front desk	Front desk
10:00 AM to 2:00 PM	Morning service. Mothers' meetups and study crowd. Midday delivery check	Morning shift
2:00 to 3:00 PM	Shift overlap and handover: open issues, bookings, stock, cash	Both Supervisors
3:00 to 6:00 PM	Workshops and book club, work and reading corner peak	Events lead, floor staff
6:00 to 9:30 PM	Evening service, private bookings, group tables	Evening shift
9:30 to 10:30 PM	Last orders at 9:30. Closing: clean, count cash, check safety, secure the building (Annex A)	Evening Supervisor
10:30 PM	Daily report sent, doors locked, staff leave safely together	Evening Supervisor

5.2 Handover

At every shift change, the outgoing Supervisor shares: open orders, unfinished tasks, any guest issues, low stock, equipment faults and cash status. The incoming Supervisor confirms by signing the handover on Annex B.

6. Service and Product Delivery

6.1 The cafe

Step	Standard
Welcome	Greet within 1 minute. Offer a seat and the menu. Ask about allergies or special needs.
Order	Repeat the order. State the price if asked. Record it in the POS or on the order slip.
Preparation	Use standard recipes and portions. Follow the food safety rules in Section 7.
Serving time	Drinks within 7 minutes, food within 15 minutes (assumed). If a delay is likely, tell the guest politely and give a time.
Check-back	Ask within 5 minutes of serving whether everything is right.
Payment	Give a clear bill, with no hidden charges. Issue a receipt.
Farewell	Thank her. Clear and reset the table within 5 minutes.

6.2 Reading and work corner

- WiFi tested every morning and every 3 hours. Speed target: at least 20 Mbps (assumed). The IT Manager is called if it fails for more than 15 minutes.
- Power sockets and charging points checked daily. Faulty sockets are marked and reported at once.
- Books are tidied twice a day. Damaged books are removed for repair.
- Guests may stay for hours. Staff do not rush them. Group work is kept polite in noise. Day Pass and membership are checked at the front desk.

6.3 Weekly events and workshops

1. **Plan** at least 7 days ahead: topic, instructor, date, capacity, materials, price and promotion. The Sales Executive and Operations Officer confirm.
2. **Prepare** the day before: room layout, materials counted, instructor briefed, register and sign-in sheet printed, and snack plan agreed.
3. **Set up** 60 minutes before the start. Test sound, WiFi and projector. Safety check of exits.
4. **Run:** start on time. The host welcomes, shares house rules and photo consent rules. The Supervisor checks the room every 20 minutes.
5. **Close:** thank guests, collect feedback, clean up, and record attendance and issues on the daily report.
6. **Follow up** within 2 days: thank-you message and feedback review.

6.4 Mothers' meetups

Morning sessions are kid-friendly. A staff member walks the area to check for hazards, such as hot drinks, sharp objects and small items. Children are always supervised by a parent or guardian. Boys up to 10 years old are allowed as set out in MEZ-SOP-002. Spills are cleaned at once.

6.5 Private bookings

Step	Action	Owner
1. Enquiry	Record needs, date, guests, budget, special wishes. Reply within the agreed response times.	Sales Executive
2. Quote	Send a clear written quote as per MEZ-SOP-008. Confirm capacity, menu and set-up.	Sales Executive
3. Confirm	Deposit received and receipt issued. Details signed off by client.	Sales Executive, Finance
4. Prepare	Staff roster, menu prep, decorations, music rules, privacy rules agreed with the host.	Operations Officer
5. Deliver	Check the space 2 hours before. A named lead stays with the group.	Supervisor
6. Close	Final bill, feedback form, photos only with consent, damage check, thank-you.	Supervisor, Sales Executive

7. Quality Assurance Checkpoints

Checkpoint	What is checked	When	Who
Opening safety and cleanliness	Exits clear, extinguishers in place, floors dry, washrooms stocked and clean, prayer area clean	Daily, before opening	Morning Supervisor
Food safety	Hand washing, clean uniforms, fridge at or below 5 °C, freezer at or below -18 °C, cooked food hot, raw and cooked food separate, dates and labels	Start of day and every 4 hours	Kitchen staff, Supervisor
Ingredient quality	Smell, look, dates, packaging, no damaged goods	At delivery and before use	Operations Officer, kitchen
Beverage standard	Taste test of chai and coffee, correct temperature and portion	Opening and every shift	Cafe counter lead
Plating and service	Correct order, neat presentation, serving time met	Each shift, spot checks	Supervisor
Cleanliness rounds	Tables, floors, washrooms, bins, prayer area, reading corner	Every 2 hours, signed on a chart	Cleaner, Supervisor
Work corner readiness	WiFi, sockets, lighting, seating, books	Daily and every 3 hours	Floor staff, IT Manager
Event readiness	Set-up, materials, safety, instructor ready	60 minutes before start	Events lead
Privacy and safety	No cameras in washrooms or the prayer area, photo rules explained, entry controlled	Daily	Security & Safety Manager
Weekly quality inspection	Whole premises against Annex E, with photos of issues and a score	Weekly	Operations Officer

Checkpoint	What is checked	When	Who
Guest feedback	Feedback forms and online reviews	Daily, summary weekly	Supervisor, Marketing Executive

If a checkpoint fails, the task is stopped or corrected immediately. Food that is unsafe or unsure is thrown away and recorded. A failed checkpoint is recorded in the daily report, and repeated or serious failures are handled under Section 11.

8. Resource and Inventory Management

8.1 Stock categories

Category	Examples	Storage rule
Perishables	Milk, eggs, dough, vegetables, fruit, desserts	Chilled. FIFO (first in, first out). Date labels
Dry goods	Tea leaves, coffee, sugar, flour, spices, syrups	Sealed containers, off the floor, dry store
Disposables and supplies	Cups, napkins, takeaway boxes, cleaning items	Dry store, counted weekly
Workshop materials	Henna, craft supplies, baking tools, books	Labelled boxes, signed out and in
Equipment	Espresso machine, stoves, fridges, chairs, sound system	Maintenance log, fault tags

8.2 Rules

- Each item has a par level (minimum). When stock reaches par, the Supervisor tells the Operations Officer, who raises a purchase request (MEZ-SOP-009).
- Deliveries are checked against the order and delivery note. Wrong or poor items are refused or recorded with the supplier.
- A weekly stock count is done on Monday morning by two people. A full count is done at month-end for the financial review.
- Wastage, spoilage and breakages are logged with a reason. Wastage above 5% of food cost in a month (assumed) triggers a review.
- Equipment is cleaned daily and serviced as planned. The Operations Officer keeps the maintenance schedule: weekly checks for small equipment, quarterly for major equipment, yearly for fire equipment.
- Chemicals are stored away from food, labelled and used as directed.

9. Work Progress Reporting

- Each task owner ticks off tasks on the allocation sheet. Open tasks are reviewed at the mid-shift check and at handover.

- The Supervisor records progress in the daily report: bookings and events, guest counts, quality results, issues, stock gaps and wins.
- Managers raise concerns in the daily huddle or in the staff WhatsApp group. Matters that need a decision are sent to the Operations Officer the same day.
- Progress against weekly goals, such as event attendance or the cleanliness score, is reviewed in the Monday meeting.

10. Handling Delays and Operational Issues

10.1 Issue levels

Level	Examples	Who acts	Response (assumed)
1. Minor	A delayed order, a missing item, a small spill, WiFi slowdown	Staff on duty, Supervisor informed	Fix at once, record if it repeats
2. Moderate	Equipment out of use, short staff, supplier late, event delayed over 15 minutes, a guest complaint	Supervisor and Operations Officer	Plan within 1 hour. Tell affected guests
3. Major	No power or water, fire alarm, food safety incident, injury, data or privacy breach, event cancelled	Operations Officer, Security & Safety Manager, CEO	Act at once. Inform CEO within 30 minutes. Follow MEZ-SOP-002

10.2 Steps for any delay or issue

1. **Make it safe.** Protect people first, then property and food.
2. **Tell the Supervisor** straight away. Do not hide or ignore it.
3. **Tell the guest** honestly, with an apology and a clear time or alternative, such as a free drink or a changed seat.
4. **Fix or work around** with the backup person, backup equipment or supplier.
5. **Record it** on the Incident and Delay Report (Annex C) before the end of the shift.
6. **Escalate** according to the levels above. Level 2 and 3 issues are reviewed under Section 11.

10.3 Common situations

Situation	Immediate action
Staff absent	Supervisor uses the standby list, moves staff between stations and tells the Operations Officer. Service targets are adjusted and guests informed.
Supplier delay	Use substitute stock from the approved list. Update the menu board. Raise a supplier note.
Power cut or generator fault	Use backup lighting. Protect fridge stock. Call the maintenance contact. Inform guests. Close if unsafe.
Equipment failure	Tag out of use. Switch to the backup method. Call the repair contact. Log it.
Event delay or cancellation	Message participants at once. Offer a new date or a refund as per MEZ-SOP-008. Inform the instructor.

Situation	Immediate action
Overcrowding (over 40 seats)	Stop new entries politely, offer a waiting list or a later time. Keep exits clear.
Guest dispute or complaint	Listen, apologise where right, solve with the Supervisor, and use the complaint steps in MEZ-SOP-008.

11. Corrective and Preventive Actions (CAPA)

11.1 When CAPA is used

CAPA is used for any Level 2 or Level 3 issue, any repeated Level 1 issue, any failed quality check, any complaint about quality or safety, and any audit finding.

11.2 Steps

Step	What happens	Time (assumed)
1. Contain	Stop the problem from spreading. Protect people and guests.	Immediately
2. Record	Open a CAPA form (Annex D) and give it a number.	Within 1 working day
3. Find the cause	Ask “why?” five times. Look at people, process, equipment, materials and environment. Do not blame individuals first.	Within 3 working days
4. Corrective action	Fix the problem and its cause. Assign an owner and a due date.	Due date set, normally within 7 days
5. Preventive action	Change a process, checklist, training or equipment so it does not return.	Within 30 days
6. Check	The Operations Officer checks that the action was done and worked. A second check is made after 30 days.	After completion and at 30 days
7. Close	The Operations Officer closes the CAPA, and the Documentation & Compliance Coordinator files it.	When effective

- The CAPA Register shows number, date, issue, cause, owner, due date, status and result. Overdue actions are reported in the weekly meeting.
- Lessons are shared with the team. Where needed, this SOP is updated.
- Serious or repeated issues go to the CEO.

11.3 Examples

Issue	Corrective action	Preventive action
Chai served cold during a rush	Re-make, apologise, check the heater	Add a temperature check to opening and 4-hourly checks. Train on batch brewing.
Event started 25 minutes late	Apologise, extend the session, thank guests	Move set-up to 60 minutes before start. Add a readiness checklist.
Milk spoiled before the date	Remove stock, record wastage	Reset par level and FIFO labels. Check fridge temperature log.

12. Operational Reports

Report	Content	Prepared by	To	When
Daily report	Opening and closing checklists, guests and sales summary, events, quality results, issues and delays, stock gaps, cash count, staff attendance	Supervisor	Operations Officer	End of each shift
Weekly report	Quality inspection score, stock count and wastage, events held and attendance, open CAPAs, feedback summary, maintenance done, next week's plan	Operations Officer	CEO, managers	Every Monday
Monthly report	Quality and safety trends, wastage and food cost, supplier performance, equipment faults, CAPA status, guest satisfaction, improvements, next month's targets	Operations Officer	CEO and Owner	By the 8th of each month

12.1 Targets (assumed)

Measure	Target
Checklists completed and signed	100% of days
Weekly quality inspection score	90% or above
Drinks served within 7 minutes	90% of orders
Events starting on time	90%
Stock count variance	Below 3%
CAPA closed on time	90%
Guest satisfaction (MEZ-SOP-008 feedback)	4.5 out of 5 or above
Level 3 issues	Zero

13. Compliance, Review and Approval

13.1 Training and acknowledgement

- Each employee is trained on the checklists and quality standards in her first week and signs an acknowledgement. Kitchen and cafe staff receive food safety training before handling food. Refresher training is held every year, and a fire drill is held twice a year.

13.2 Compliance checks

Check	Frequency	Responsible
Opening and closing checklists complete	Weekly	Operations Officer
Weekly quality inspection	Weekly	Operations Officer

Check	Frequency	Responsible
Food safety and hygiene audit	Monthly	Operations Officer and Security & Safety Manager
Stock count compared to records	Weekly and monthly	Operations Officer and Finance Director
CAPA Register reviewed, overdue items escalated	Weekly	Operations Officer
Fire, safety and first aid equipment	Monthly	Security & Safety Manager
Records filed and complete	Quarterly	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator
Full review of this SOP	Yearly	CEO and Owner

13.3 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by: Operations Officer			
Reviewed by: HR / Sales / Marketing Manager			
Approved by: CEO			
Approved by: Owner			

Annex A. Daily Opening and Closing Checklist (MEZ-FRM-048)

Task (date: _____ shift: _____)	Done (initials)
OPENING: premises unlocked and safety walk-through done	
OPENING: exits clear, extinguishers in place, first aid kit stocked	
OPENING: fridge and freezer temperatures recorded	
OPENING: washrooms and prayer area clean and stocked	
OPENING: floors, tables and reading corner ready	
OPENING: equipment on, WiFi and POS tested	
OPENING: float and stock checked, huddle held	
CLOSING: last orders taken at 9:30 PM and guests thanked	
CLOSING: kitchen cleaned, food covered, labelled and stored	
CLOSING: equipment off, gas and water checked	
CLOSING: cash counted by two people, safe locked	
CLOSING: rubbish out, doors and windows secured, alarm set	
CLOSING: daily report sent. Signed by Supervisor	

Annex B. Daily Task Allocation and Handover Sheet (MEZ-FRM-049)

Date: _____ Shift: _____ Supervisor: _____ Handover received by: _____

Task	Owner and backup	Time due	Done	Notes

Annex C. Incident and Delay Report (MEZ-FRM-050)

Field	Details
Report number, date and time	
Reported by and role	
Level (1, 2 or 3)	
What happened and where	
People affected (guests, staff, event)	
Immediate action taken	
Informed (names and times)	

Field	Details
Guest compensation or apology offered	
CAPA needed? (Yes / No, CAPA number)	
Supervisor signature and date	

Annex D. Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) Form (MEZ-FRM-051)

Field	Details
CAPA number and date opened	
Issue and where it was found	
Containment action taken	
Root cause (5 whys)	
Corrective action, owner and due date	
Preventive action, owner and due date	
Check after completion (date, result, by)	
Check after 30 days (date, result, by)	
Status and closed by (date)	

Annex E. Weekly Quality Inspection Checklist (MEZ-FRM-052)

Week: _____ Inspector: _____ Score (out of 100): _____ Areas: entrance, seating, work corner, books, kitchen, counter, storage, washrooms, prayer area, safety equipment, event room.

Area	Standard met? (Y / N)	Finding or photo ref.	Action and owner